Services are quite generic components—they might be anything. We can classify them according to whether they store any kind of state, distinguishing between *application services* (stateless) and *data services* (stateful).

Figure 1.14 shows the elements of a cloud native architecture. An application used to manage the inventory for a book library would be an application service. A PostgreSQL database used to store information about the books would be a data service.

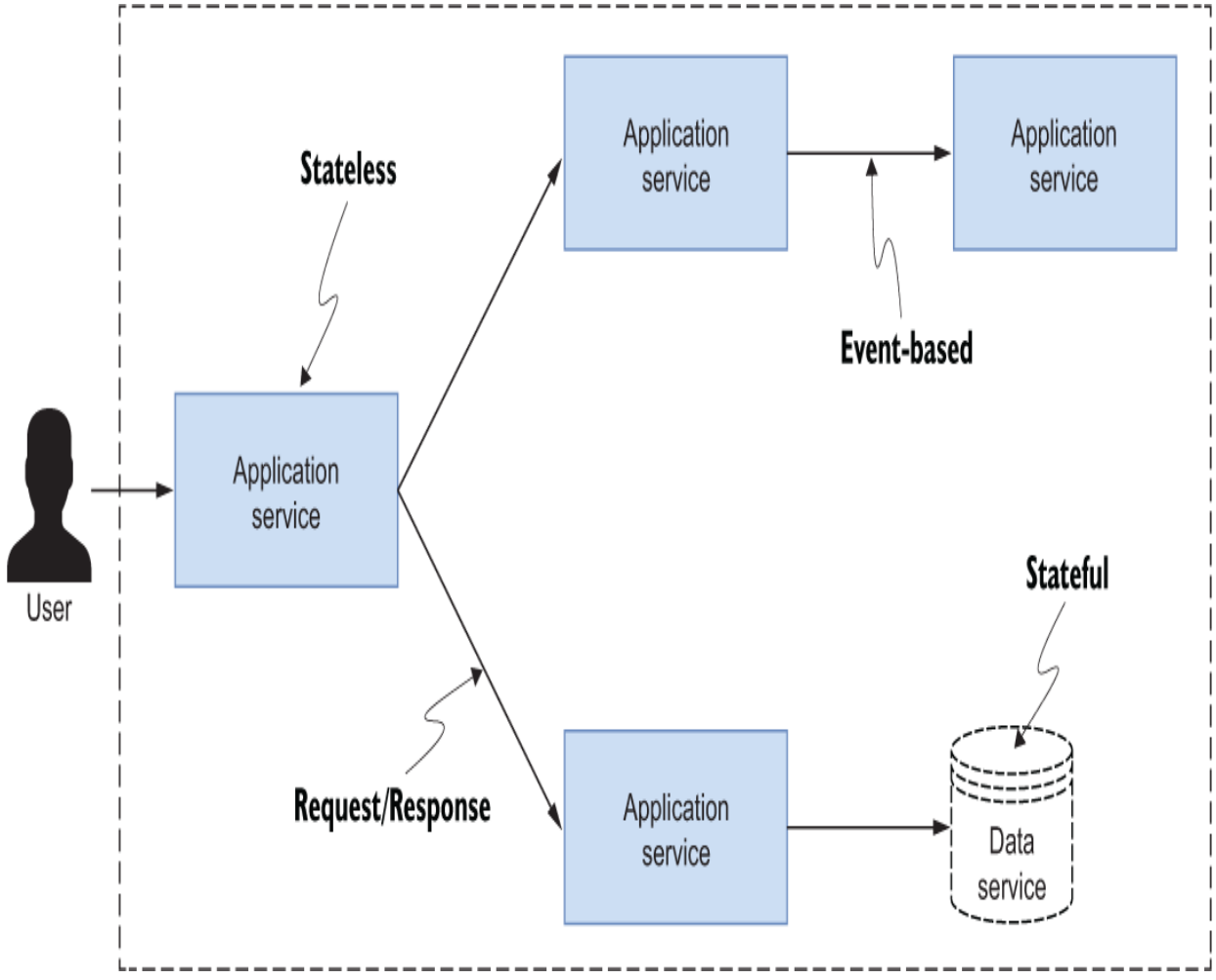


Figure 1.14 Service-based architecture for cloud native applications. The main elements are services (application or data) that interact with